

Fixing the phone list and finding Quantlab's Chicago path

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

99 Data Center intent, audience A (Sep 5)	8 dials on Sep 29, 0 live conversations	4 of 6 phone numbers were dead or wrong	Houston HQ: Chicago is where its orders land
STAGE Wave B prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Quantlab (Wave B), 8 leads; 3 added Sep 28	LAST TOUCH Sep 29: 8 calls (voicemails to Chris Sams, Ronny Obando)	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: email Robert Rubio and Ronny Obando with one Chicago question

Bottom line

Quantlab is a Houston proprietary trading firm (about 150 people) whose orders go to Chicago's futures and options markets. ZoomInfo shows a **Data Center intent score of 99 with the largest audience (A)** on Sep 5. You did the work on Sep 29 with eight calls, but **four of the six numbers were dead, parked at Number Barn, or wrong**. That's a data problem, not a rejection. The owner is **Robert Rubio (VP of Infrastructure)**, and the design lead is **Ronny Obando (Lead Network Architect, Trading Infrastructure)**, who hung up mid-voicemail. Both have verified emails. The plan is to stop dialing bad numbers and send two short emails asking how Quantlab's Chicago presence is connected.

What Quantlab is, in one analogy

Quantlab's research lives in Houston, but its orders have to show up in Chicago. Think of a Texas bakery that sells at a Chicago farmers' market: the bread is made at home, but the stall and the delivery route are what make the sale. You own part of the route at the Chicago end.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Data Center intent 99 (audience A), Sep 5, 2026	ZoomInfo intent	Top score, biggest audience. Someone is actively evaluating data center or colocation.
Robert Rubio: VP of Infrastructure since 2022, promoted through Head of Infrastructure and IT Director	Apollo	Long-tenured owner. Knows every circuit; respects specifics.
Ronny Obando: Lead Network Architect, Trading Infrastructure (2022), 10 years at Quantlab	Apollo	He designs the trading paths. He hung up mid-voicemail, so give him something readable instead.
Headcount down about 6% over 12 months (Apollo)	Apollo	Cost discipline. Frame diversity as risk reduction, not an upgrade.
Phone data: Olmstead and another number parked at Number Barn; Steven Brooks wrong number; Sujith's line goes to a phone tree	Lemlist call notes, Sep 29	Update these records before anyone else dials them.

Check first

HubSpot has Quantlab twice: 'Quantlab Financial, LLC' (Houston, 58005815336, the active record) and 'Quantlab Financial' (58841072649, created Sep 30). Merge them before the Salesforce upload, keeping the Houston record.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 11-15	Wave B, visits + email 1	'Route diversity after the Zayo + Crown Castle consolidation' to Rubio, Obando, Sams, Olmstead, Samarasinghe	No replies
Sep 16-17	Wave B, LinkedIn invites	Invites to all 5	None accepted
Sep 23-24	Wave B, email 2	'The part of your path map you can't see'	No replies
Sep 28	Wave B, new leads	Travis Leconey, Jin Feng, Peter Luong added	Step 1 skipped Sep 30

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 29	Phone (8 calls)	VM to Chris Sams (conduit redundancy); Obando hung up mid-VM; Olmstead's number parked; Samarasinghe phone tree; Rubio via front desk, no answer; Brooks wrong number	Bad phone data

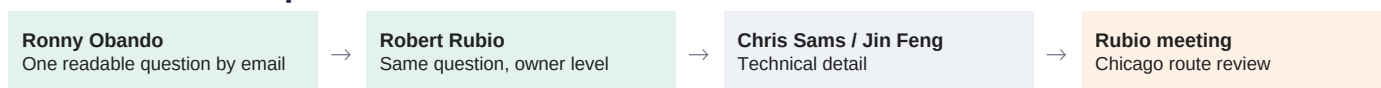
Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Robert Rubio	VP of Infrastructure (HubSpot, Apollo)	Driftwood, TX	Owner of infrastructure spend.	Wave B, no reply. rrubio@quantlab.com (verified). No direct phone
Ronny Obando	Lead Network Architect, Trading Infrastructure (Apollo)	Houston	Designs the paths into Chicago.	Wave B; hung up mid-VM. robando@quantlab.com (verified)
Chris Sams	Senior Infrastructure Engineer (HubSpot)	St. Louis area (314)	Got your VM on conduit redundancy; hands-on.	Wave B, VM Sep 29
Jin Feng	Network Engineer (HubSpot)	Houston	Added Sep 28. Technical follow-up only.	Wave B, step 1 skipped
Sujith Samarasinghe	Trading Infrastructure (HubSpot)	n/a	Trading-side infrastructure; adjacent.	Wave B; need a working number

Not worth chasing for this goal

Jeff Olmstead (Manager, IT Infrastructure) looks like corporate IT; his number is dead. Chris Karpinsky (Manager, Research Infrastructure, Boston) runs research compute, not trading paths. Ninnian H. (IT Security) is out of scope.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Ronny Obando Lead Network Architect, Trading Infrastructure

Why them: He hung up on the voicemail; give him something he can answer in one line.

Channel: Email, Mon Oct 5 | Subject: Quantlab's last mile in Chicago

Ronny, sorry for the voicemail last week; email is easier. One question: when Quantlab's traffic reaches Chicago, do your two paths into your racks share any conduit in the last mile? Crosstown owns underground fiber there and maps every duct. Happy to send our map so you can check.

2. Robert Rubio VP of Infrastructure

Why them: Owner. Tie to the data center research signal without naming it.

Channel: Email, Tue Oct 6 | Subject: If Chicago data center plans are moving

Robert, if Quantlab is reviewing Chicago data center or colocation options this year, the fiber between sites is often decided last and regretted first. Crosstown owns an underground ring in Chicago. Worth 15 minutes to see where it runs before decisions lock in?

3. Chris Sams Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Why them: Follow-up to the voicemail he received.

Channel: Email, Thu Oct 8 | Subject: Following up on my voicemail

Chris, following up on the voicemail I left on the 29th about conduit-level redundancy in Chicago. If it's easier, I can send a map and you can tell me if there's anything worth discussing.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Thu Oct 1	Update HubSpot: mark Olmstead's and Brooks' numbers invalid; note that Samarasinghe's line goes to a phone tree.	Stops repeat dialing of dead numbers.
Fri Oct 2	Merge the two Quantlab company records. Pause Rubio and Obando in Wave B.	-
Mon Oct 5	Email Ronny Obando.	-
Tue Oct 6	Email Robert Rubio.	-
Thu Oct 8	Email Chris Sams.	-
Mon Oct 12	Run ZoomInfo phone enrichment for Rubio and Obando (direct dials).	Credits pre-approved.
Week of Oct 19	Call Rubio and Obando on the new numbers.	-
Week of Oct 26	Goal: Chicago route review with Obando.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 9	Phone data cleaned; 3 personal emails sent	HubSpot updated
Oct 30	Reply from Obando or Rubio	Email or call logged

Guardrails

- Don't assume where Quantlab colocates; ask.
- Credits used: 4 Apollo person enrichments; ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.
- Merge duplicate HubSpot records before the Salesforce upload.

Sources

HubSpot (two company records, contacts, call notes Sep 29); Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Quantlab (Wave B)' activity; ZoomInfo intent (Sep 5); Apollo people and organization data (Oct 1, 2026).